

✓ A practical guide for admins and agents

THE AI-ASSISTED SUPPORT ADVANTAGE

Design support for minutes, not days.

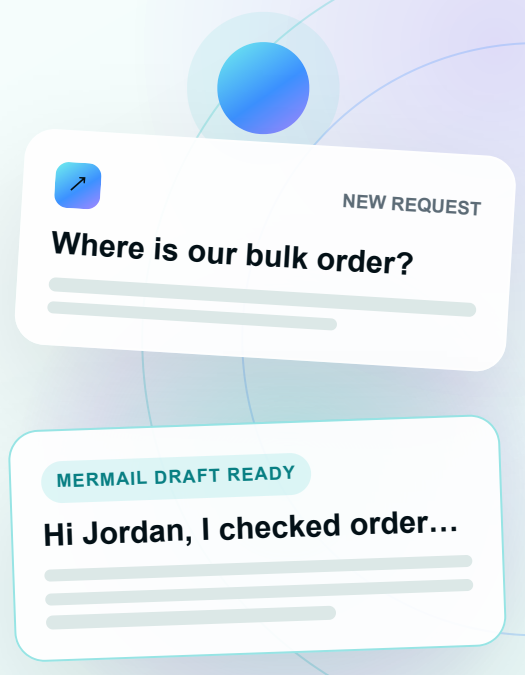
Route the right email, prepare grounded first drafts, and let one focused owner control the customer experience.

5-step setup

AI-assisted workflow

Human stays in control

✓ Human reviews before send



A HIGH-LEVERAGE SUPPORT MODEL CAN TARGET

Illustrative targets · measure against your own baseline

~~Days~~ → **Minutes**

Routine first-draft preparation when forwarding, triage, and knowledge are ready.

1 focused owner

Oversees intake, knowledge, exceptions, and final reply decisions.

100% reviewed

Every AI-assisted draft passes through a human before it is sent.

YOUR FIVE-STEP PATH TO GO LIVE

01

Forward email

Gmail or Outlook

02

Add domain

› Verify DNS records

03

Test triage

› Review prepared drafts

04

Add rules

› Labels and urgency

05

Add knowledge

› Policies and guides

PREPARE ONCE

Gather access and safe test data

You can complete the setup faster when the right people and test accounts are ready.

GOAL

Prepare everything needed for the five setup jobs.

Do not use real customer secrets, payment details, or confidential attachments during testing.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- ✓ **Mermail admin access** for mailbox, domain, and support-rule configuration.
- ✓ **A Mermail mailbox address** that can receive a forwarding confirmation.
- ✓ **Gmail or Outlook settings access**, plus administrator approval if external forwarding is blocked.
- ✓ **DNS access** and a Developer or Enterprise workspace for a custom domain.
- ✓ **Three approved knowledge files** such as shipping, returns, and invoice guidance.

CHECK IT WORKED

You are ready when you can open the Mermail inbox, email-provider settings, workspace settings, and DNS dashboard.

STEPS

1 Choose your support address.

Example: existing `support@example.com` or new `support@mail.example.com`.

2 Choose your forwarding boundary.

Start with messages sent to the support address—not the entire personal inbox.

3 Create two safe test messages.

One should match the forwarding rule. One should be excluded.

4 Prepare one urgent example.

Example: "Our production order is blocked today."

5 Prepare one normal example.

Example: "Please send another invoice copy."

TROUBLESHOOTING

Missing admin access? Ask an existing workspace admin, email administrator, or DNS owner before continuing. Do not work around organization security policy.

SETUP JOB 1A

Forward selected Gmail messages

Use a Gmail filter so Mermail receives support mail without receiving the whole inbox.

[Gmail path](#) · [Settings](#) → [See all settings](#) → [Forwarding and POP/IMAP](#)

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Have the Mermail mailbox address ready. Ask your Google Workspace admin whether external forwarding is allowed.

STEPS

1

Add a forwarding address.

Enter the Mermail mailbox and confirm the Gmail prompts.

2

Approve the request.

Open the verification message in Mermail and follow the confirmation link.

3

Keep account-wide forwarding disabled.

A selective filter can still use the verified address.

4

Create a positive filter.

Use Gmail search options, for example `to:support@example.com`.

5

Choose Forward it.

Select the Mermail address, save the filter, and send two new tests.

Gmail · Create a filter

support@example.com

To

support@example.com

Doesn't have

payroll OR password reset

Forward it to

support@mermail.app

Apply the label

Mermail support

Create filter

— Prefer a short positive rule over account-wide forwarding with many exceptions.

CHECK IT WORKED

- ✓ The matching new message appears in Mermail.
- ✓ The excluded message stays only in Gmail.
- ✓ The original sender and subject are readable.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Address unavailable: complete the verification link in Mermail.

Everything forwards: disable account-wide forwarding and keep only the selective filter.

Human takeover: if someone replies directly from Gmail, Mermail permanently stops AI processing for that entire thread. Continue the thread in Gmail after takeover.

SETUP JOB 1B

Redirect selected Outlook messages

Use an Outlook rule with **Redirect to** so Mermail sees the original customer as the sender.

Outlook path · Settings → Mail → Rules → Add new rule

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Have the Mermail address ready. Microsoft 365 administrators may block automatic forwarding outside the organization.

STEPS

1

Create a named rule.

Example: "Redirect support mail to Mermail."

2

Add a narrow condition.

Use recipient, sender, subject, or another supported field.

3

Add sensitive-mail exceptions.

Keep payroll, password resets, legal, and private mail outside the rule.

4

Select Redirect to.

Enter the Mermail mailbox. Redirect preserves the original sender identity.

5

Save and test.

Send one matching and one excluded new message.

Outlook · Add new rule

Save

Rule name

Redirect support mail to Mermail

Condition

Sent to support@example.com

Action

Redirect to support@mermail.app

Exception

Subject includes "password reset"

Save rule

— **Redirect** usually fits support better than **Forward** because it preserves the customer sender.

CHECK IT WORKED

- ✓ The matching new message reaches Mermail.
- ✓ The excluded message does not reach Mermail.
- ✓ Mermail shows the original customer sender.

TROUBLESHOOTING

No delivery: ask your Microsoft 365 admin whether outbound automatic forwarding is blocked.

Wrong sender: use **Redirect to** instead of **Forward to**.

Human takeover: replying directly from Outlook permanently hands the entire thread to a human and stops later Mermail AI processing.

Other providers: use the Mermail forwarding guides for iCloud Mail, Proton Mail, Yahoo Mail, and Lark Mail.

SETUP JOB 2A

Add and verify your subdomain

Use a dedicated subdomain so Mermail does not replace the MX records for your organization's existing root email.

Mermail path · Workspace Settings → Domains → Add domain

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Developer+

Plan includes custom domains.

Admin

Workspace admin access.

DNS

Permission to publish records.

STEPS

1 Choose a dedicated subdomain.

Use `mail.example.com` or `support.mail.example.com`. Do not use `example.com`.

2 Add the complete subdomain.

Mermail provisions the domain and returns the required DNS records.

3 Publish every returned record.

Copy type, name, value, and MX priority exactly. Do not guess SPF, DKIM, MX, or DMARC values.

4 Wait for DNS propagation.

Check that your DNS provider did not append the parent domain twice.

5 Click Verify in Mermail.

Retry safely after correcting a record or waiting for propagation.

Domains

Add domain

Domain

mail.example.com

Status

pending

TXT · resend._domainkey

Copy

MX · send

Copy

TXT · send

Copy

Verify

The exact records shown by Mermail are the source of truth.

CHECK IT WORKED

The domain status is **verified** and Mermail shows a verification time.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Rejected domain: use a subdomain with at least three labels.

Still pending: compare every DNS field, wait for propagation, then verify again.

Name duplicated: use the relative host format expected by your DNS provider.

Do not use a bare root domain. Mermail rejects it, and replacing root-domain MX records could disrupt existing company email.

SETUP JOB 2B

Create and test the support mailbox

After the domain is verified, create a customer-facing mailbox and test delivery in both directions.

Mermail path · Mailboxes → New mailbox → Select verified domain

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

The custom domain must show **verified** .
Choose a clear username such as **support** .

STEPS

- 1 Open New mailbox.**
Select the workspace that owns the verified domain.
- 2 Select the custom domain.**
Choose **mail.example.com** from the available domains.
- 3 Enter the username and name.**
Example: **support@mail.example.com** and "Customer Support."
- 4 Send an inbound test.**
From an outside account, email the new address and confirm it appears in Mermail.
- 5 Send an outbound reply.**
Confirm the recipient, sender address, display name, subject, and thread.

Create mailbox

Workspace: Northstar

Mailbox name
Customer Support

Username
support

Domain
mail.example.com **verified**

COMPLETE ADDRESS

support@mail.example.com

Create mailbox

■ A verified domain becomes selectable when you create the mailbox.

CHECK IT WORKED

- ✓ Inbound test appears in the Inbox.
- ✓ Outbound reply arrives at the external account.
- ✓ Sender is the custom-domain address.
- ✓ Reply remains in the same thread.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Domain missing: confirm its status is verified in the same workspace.

Cannot receive: recheck domain DNS status and the mailbox receiving state.

Do not publish the address yet if either inbound delivery or the outbound reply test fails.

SETUP JOB 3

Test the default email triager

Every mailbox has a protected triager that prepares inbound customer replies as drafts for human review.

Mermail path · Mailbox sidebar → Task triager → Default email response triager

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Use a safe external account to send a new customer-style message into the mailbox Inbox.

STEPS

1 Open Task triager.
Find **Default email response triager**. It is created automatically.

2 Send a new inbound test.
Ask a clear support question, such as an order-status request.

3 Wait for the prepared draft.
The triager uses the thread, mailbox context, and built-in customer-care instructions.

4 Open the draft and Agent.
Review the linked triager conversation and the generated reply.

5 Edit before sending.
Verify customer identity, order facts, promises, dates, links, and attachments.

Task triager

Default

NAME

Default email response triager

STATUS

Protected

New email received

Inbox only

Open Agent

New email received

Completed

Reply saved

Draft review

The default triager saves a draft. It does not send that draft automatically.

CHECK IT WORKED

- ✓ The inbound message appears in Inbox.
- ✓ A linked reply appears in Drafts.
- ✓ The triager Agent conversation shows the outcome.
- ✓ No reply is sent until a person approves it.

TROUBLESHOOTING

No draft: confirm the message is new, in Inbox, and not bulk or automated mail.

Wrong facts: correct the draft and improve trusted Knowledge instead of sending it unchanged.

Current limitation: a custom instruction-only mail triager does not run those instructions on received or sent mail. Use the protected default triager for inbound reply drafts. Custom instructions run for supported Google Calendar triagers.

SETUP JOB 4

Add labels and precise urgency rules

Use current console rules to organize requests and highlight messages that truly need attention today.

Mermail path · Mailbox Settings → Custom labels and Urgent email detection

A. CUSTOM LABELS

Goal: make each label change how the team handles the message.

1 Open Manage labels.

Select **Add label**.

2 Name one support decision.

Examples: Order status, Invoice, Damaged shipment, VIP.

3 Write a specific rule.

Example: "Damage, shortage, missing cartons, or unusable goods."

4 Save and enable detection.

New inbound mail will be checked against the rules.

Label: Damaged shipment
Rule: Customer reports damage, shortage, missing cartons, or goods that cannot be used.

B. URGENT EMAIL DETECTION

Goal: reserve urgent badges and stronger alerts for work that needs attention today.

1 Enable urgent detection.

Built-in defaults apply when the custom field is empty.

2 Add custom rules only when needed.

Custom rules fully replace the built-in defaults.

3 Name concrete signals.

Use sender, domain, subject, deadline, outage, or operational impact.

4 Save and test two messages.

One should be urgent and one should remain normal.

Urgent:

- Production is blocked today.
- A payment failure blocks order release.
- A VIP customer has a same-day deadline.

Not urgent:

- Routine invoice-copy requests.
- General catalog questions.

CHECK IT WORKED

The damaged-order test receives the correct label and urgent badge. The routine invoice-copy test is labeled but not urgent.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Too many matches: replace broad words like "important" with concrete senders, subjects, deadlines, and business impact.

Rules organize and prioritize. They do not assign an owner, start an SLA timer, or authorize a refund, replacement, credit, or shipment change.

SETUP JOB 5

Connect and test trusted Knowledge

Upload approved policies and guides so the Agent can retrieve relevant context when helping with a customer conversation.

Mermail path · Open Assistant → Knowledge

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Prepare current, approved documents with an owner and effective date.

.txt .md .markdown text-based .pdf

15 MB maximum

STEPS

1 Open the Knowledge tab.

The panel checks or prepares your secure knowledge connection.

2 Connect or reconnect when prompted.

Wait until the status is active before uploading.

3 Upload one focused document.

Start with a shipping, returns, invoice, or wholesale policy.

4 Confirm the indexed document.

Open the document details and check that useful text was extracted.

5 Ask the Agent a test question.

Compare the answer with the source document before using it with customers.

Agent, Knowledge & Integrations

Agent

Knowledge

Integrations

Indexed knowledge

active

Upload documents

Drop a supported file here

Shipping-policy.pdf

Indexed

Returns-guide.md

Indexed

Invoice-help.txt

Indexed

— Use one authoritative topic per file. Replace obsolete guidance promptly.

CHECK IT WORKED

- ✓ Connection status is active.
- ✓ The file appears in Indexed knowledge.
- ✓ Document details contain readable text.
- ✓ The Agent retrieves the correct policy answer.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Unsupported: convert the file to text, Markdown, or a text-based PDF.

Too large: reduce it below 15 MB or split it by topic.

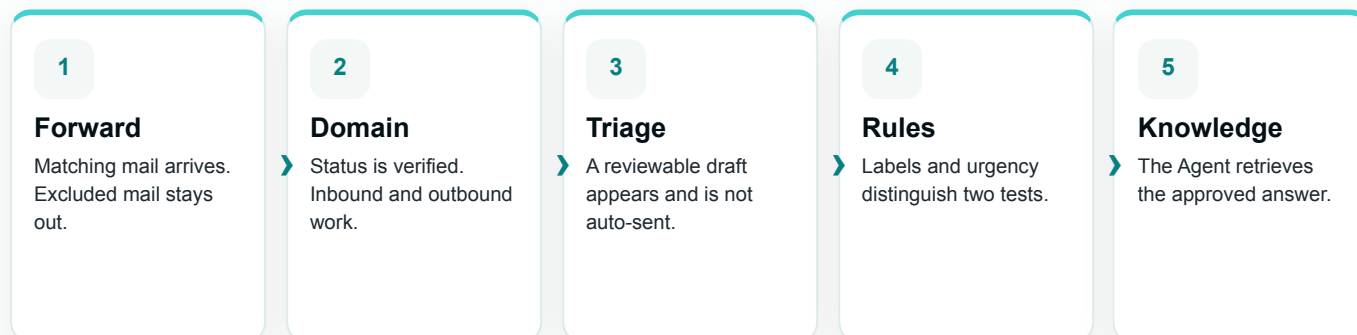
Empty PDF text: use a searchable PDF rather than a scan made only of images.

Never upload secrets or raw customer exports. Live order, stock, payment, and account facts still require verification in a trusted business system.

FINAL CHECK

Test the complete support workflow

Publish the support address only after each setup job passes its simple success check.



GO-LIVE CHECKLIST

- ✓ Selective Gmail or Outlook rule is enabled.
- ✓ Matching and excluded messages behave correctly.
- ✓ Custom domain is verified, when used.
- ✓ Inbound and outbound custom-domain tests pass.
- ✓ Default triager creates a draft for review.
- ✓ A person verifies and approves every reply.
- ✓ Custom labels match the intended requests.
- ✓ Only same-day critical messages become urgent.
- ✓ Knowledge files are current and searchable.
- ✓ Team knows that provider replies cause human takeover.

FAST TROUBLESHOOTING

PROBLEM	FIRST CHECK
Forwarding confirmation missing	Mermail Inbox and spam; destination address.
Outlook rule does nothing	Organization external-forwarding policy.
Domain remains pending	DNS type, name, value, priority, and propagation.
Domain not selectable	Verified status and correct workspace.
No triager draft	New message is in Inbox and not automated mail.
Too many urgent messages	Replace broad custom rules with precise criteria.
Knowledge upload fails	Supported type, searchable text, and size below 15 MB.

READY TO LAUNCH

Fast where the facts are clear. Human where the decision matters.

Mermail can organize messages, retrieve context, and prepare language. Your support team owns identity checks, business decisions, commitments, and the final send.

Pause launch if forwarding exposes unintended mail, the domain cannot send or receive, drafts contain unverified facts, or the team has not agreed on human review.